

PITCH STRATEGY

Make the problem clear.
Make the value memorable.

THE CORE IDEA

A strong pitch is not a tour of everything you built.

It is a focused story: what you learned, what matters, what you built, why it fits, and what changed because of it.

01

HOOK

02

PROBLEM

03

INSIGHT

04

SOLUTION

05

DEMO

06

IMPACT

PITCH WITH INTENT

Clarity beats complexity.

Build a story, not a feature list

Your audience should understand the customer journey before they judge the technology.

01 HOOK

Open with the customer reality.

Give the audience a reason to care before explaining your build.

02 PROBLEM

State the problem precisely.

Who experiences it? What friction exists? Why does it matter?

03 DISCOVERY INSIGHT

Show what you learned.

Use the strongest signal, pattern, or customer constraint that shaped your direction.

04 SOLUTION

Explain your recommendation.

Describe what changes for the user - not every technical component.

05 DEMO

Prove the core experience.

Show the shortest path from problem to value. Narrate why each step matters.

06 IMPACT

Land the value.

Connect the solution to the expected business or user outcome and next step.

THE TEST

If the audience remembers only three things, make them the problem, your recommendation, and the value.

Design slides for the room

Slides support the speaker. They should not compete with the speaker.

01 ONE IDEA PER SLIDE

Each slide should answer one question or make one point.

02 HEADLINES = CONCLUSIONS

Use titles like 'Manual handoffs create duplicate work' instead of 'Current State'.

03 SHOW, DON'T TRANSCRIBE

Prefer a diagram, workflow, metric, screenshot, or short phrase over paragraphs.

04 USE NUMBERS WITH CONTEXT

A metric is useful only when the audience understands what it represents.

05 KEEP VISUAL HIERARCHY

The most important idea should be the easiest thing to see.

06 REMOVE EVERYTHING EXTRA

If an element does not help the story, delete it.

GOOD SLIDE QUESTION

Can someone understand the main point in a few seconds without reading a paragraph?

Demo the value - not the architecture

The demo is evidence that your recommendation can become real.

01 SET THE SCENE

Remind the audience who the user is and what they are trying to accomplish.

02 SHOW THE INPUT

Use a realistic starting point that connects directly to Discovery.

03 SHOW THE CHANGE

Demonstrate the core capability that removes friction or enables a better decision.

04 SHOW THE OUTCOME

Make the before-versus-after difference obvious.

DEMO DISCIPLINE

- Use safe demo data. Never expose credentials, secrets, or sensitive customer information.
- Know what is live, mocked, or simulated - and be transparent if asked.
- Have screenshots or a backup path for any critical dependency that could fail.

Present like a team

Executive presence is clarity, ownership, and control - not sounding overly formal.

OPEN WITH CONFIDENCE

Start immediately. Avoid long introductions, apologies, or explaining what you did not finish.

HANDOFF WITH PURPOSE

Each speaker should know exactly why they are taking over and what point they own.

SPEAK TO THE AUDIENCE

Do not read the screen. Use the slide as a visual anchor while you explain the story.

USE PLAIN LANGUAGE

Explain technical ideas in terms of user behavior, business impact, risk, or decision-making.

CONTROL THE PACE

Pause after important points. Rushing makes strong ideas sound uncertain.

CLOSE TOGETHER

End with one clear recommendation and the impact your team believes it can create.

TEAM RULE

Everyone should understand the full story - even if each person owns only one section.

Treat Q&A like another discovery conversation

Questions are not interruptions. They reveal what your audience needs to trust the recommendation.

01 LISTEN FULLY

Do not start answering halfway through the question.

02 ANSWER THE QUESTION FIRST

Lead with the direct answer, then add context.

03 USE EVIDENCE

Return to Discovery, assumptions, tests, and tradeoffs instead of guessing.

04 BE CLEAR ABOUT LIMITS

If something is not known, say what you know, what you assumed, and how you would validate it.

05 DEFEND THE LOGIC, NOT YOUR EGO

A challenge to the idea is not a challenge to the team.

06 BRIDGE BACK TO VALUE

After technical detail, reconnect the answer to the customer problem or impact.

USEFUL RESPONSE STRUCTURE

Answer → Evidence → Tradeoff or limitation → What you would do next.

Before you pitch

Run this final review as a team before presenting.

☐**STORY**

The pitch has a clear beginning, middle, and end.

☐**PROBLEM**

The customer problem is specific and grounded in Discovery.

☐**ALIGNMENT**

The recommendation reflects customer readiness, constraints, and priorities.

☐**SOLUTION**

We can explain the solution in plain language before discussing technology.

☐**DEMO**

The demo follows the shortest path from customer problem to value.

☐**IMPACT**

We can explain the expected outcome and how success could be measured.

☐**SLIDES**

Every slide has one clear point and supports the speaker.

☐**TIMING**

We have rehearsed and know how long each section takes.

☐**HANDOFFS**

Speaker transitions are intentional and practiced.

☐**Q&A**

Every team member understands the problem, recommendation, tradeoffs, and key assumptions.

☐**BACKUP**

Critical demo moments have a fallback if a dependency fails.

☐**CLOSE**

The final statement reinforces the recommendation and customer value.

FINAL REMINDER

You are not pitching the technology. You are pitching why this solution should exist.